

PROPEDGE / INTERNAL BRIEF

Commercial & Legal Readiness Plan

A founder's reference for moving PropEdge from personal tool to public, and eventually paid, sports analytics product — without stepping on legal trip-wires.

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NOT LEGAL ADVICE

This document is an internal product and operations reference. It is **not legal advice** and does not create an attorney-client relationship. Before charging users, adding affiliate links, selling picks, marketing best bets, or launching in any new jurisdiction, consult a licensed attorney with sports betting / gaming, advertising, and data-licensing experience.

4 USE CASES TODAY	7 LEGAL PAGES TO ADD	90 DAYS TO COMMERCIAL-READY	0 WAGERS ACCEPTED
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01

Executive Status

PropEdge is a working sports analytics tool. From a legal and commercial standpoint, today's version is fine for personal use and arguably fine for a tightly disclaimed private beta. The bigger commercial paths — paid subscriptions, selling picks, and sportsbook affiliate revenue — are not yet ready and should not launch without targeted legal, data, and compliance work.

USE CASE	STATUS	NOTES
Personal / internal use	READY	No external users, no monetization, no public claims. Lowest risk surface.
Private beta (invited testers)	READY WITH DISCLAIMERS	Add in-app disclaimer, age acknowledgement, NDA-style invite terms, and a feedback channel.
Public free beta	READY AFTER LEGAL PAGES	Requires Terms, Privacy, Responsible Gambling, AI Limitations, and Data Sources pages live before launch.
Paid subscriptions / selling picks	NOT READY	Charging changes the legal posture materially. Requires attorney review, refund policy, billing terms, tax setup.
Sportsbook affiliate model	NOT READY	State-by-state gaming advertising rules. Most operators require a vetted affiliate agreement and licensing review.

Main blockers

LEGAL POSITIONING How PropEdge describes itself in marketing, UI, and Terms determines whether it reads as analytics or as a wagering service.	DATA LICENSING Stats, odds, headshots, and logos pulled from public pages are not automatically cleared for commercial use.
DISCLAIMERS Users need clear, persistent notice that PropEdge is informational, not a sportsbook, and not financial advice.	COMMERCIAL COMPLIANCE Charging users, affiliate links, and pick sales each open new regulatory surfaces (consumer protection, gaming, tax, advertising).

02 Lowest-Resistance Legal Positioning

Position PropEdge as a **sports analytics and educational decision-support product** — not a sportsbook, not a betting exchange, not a tout service, and not a paid wagering facilitator. This framing is consistent with how the product actually works (it analyzes; it does not accept wagers) and keeps PropEdge out of regulated activity categories in most U.S. jurisdictions.

AVOID — DIRECTIVE BETTING LANGUAGE

Words that imply a sure outcome, a directive to wager, or insider access shift the product toward looking like a paid pick / tout service.

- Guaranteed
- Lock
- Risk-free
- Sure thing
- Free money
- Insider
- Must bet

PREFER — ANALYTICAL LABELS

Labels that describe model output and research signals — not directives to act.

- Model Watchlist
- Highest-Rated Props
- Research Leans
- PropEdge Signals
- Market Notes

Positioning principles

- Describe outputs as **models, ratings, and signals**, not picks or plays a user must take.
- Show **process and methodology**, not just outcomes — this reinforces the educational/analytics framing.
- Reinforce in copy that PropEdge does not accept wagers and is not affiliated with any sportsbook (until and unless a vetted affiliate deal is in place).
- Keep marketing claims about accuracy or returns conservative and well-sourced; avoid testimonials that promise wins.

03 Code & Product Changes Recommended

These are product-level controls that operationalize the legal positioning. They protect users, reduce regulatory exposure, and make later commercial moves materially easier.

AGE ACKNOWLEDGEMENT Modal or onboarding step requiring users to confirm 21+ (or local legal age) before viewing odds-related content.	SOURCE LABELS Every data point shows where it came from (e.g., ESPN, RotoWire, odds provider) and a timestamp.
AI / PROP AI LIMITATIONS Visible note wherever model output is shown: probabilistic, may be wrong, not advice.	NO SPORTSBOOK EXECUTION Do not deep-link, embed bet slips, or pre-fill wagers unless a reviewed affiliate / gaming-compliance path exists.
COMMERCIAL-SAFE MODE FLAG A single feature flag that toggles all unlicensed assets to placeholders and disables sportsbook deep links.	PERSISTENT FOOTER DISCLAIMER In-app footer carries the informational-tool disclaimer on every page that shows odds, props, or AI output.

Suggested commercial-safe mode behavior

When `commercialSafeMode = true`, the app should:

- Hide unlicensed logos and player headshots; render generic placeholders or initials.
- Limit article text to short summaries; show source headlines and outbound links instead of reproducing body copy.
- Pull player, team, and odds data only from approved or licensed APIs.
- Disable sportsbook deep links unless the linked operator is covered by a current, signed affiliate agreement.
- Stamp every model output card with the AI/PropAI limitations note and the data-source citation.

04 Legal Pages & Disclaimer Templates

Before public free beta, the seven pages below should be linked from the footer and reachable from the onboarding flow. Treat them as living documents — an attorney should review them before any paid launch.

PAGE	WHAT IT COVERS
Terms of Service	Account rules, acceptable use, IP ownership, limitation of liability, dispute resolution, governing law.
Privacy Policy	What data you collect, why, how it's stored, third-party processors, user rights, contact for requests.
Responsible Gambling	Age requirement, problem-gambling resources, links to state hotlines, self-exclusion guidance.
PropIQ Methodology	How ratings are produced, what inputs are used, known limitations, update cadence.
AI / PropAI Limitations	Probabilistic nature, training data caveats, hallucination risk, human-in-the-loop guidance.
Data Sources & Attribution	Vendors, licensed APIs, public-domain content, attribution required by each provider.
Contact / Support	Support email, response-time expectations, security/abuse reporting address, takedown contact.

In-app disclaimer template

"PropEdge is an informational analytics tool. It does not accept wagers, place bets, guarantee outcomes, or provide financial, legal, or gambling advice. Odds, lines, injuries, and availability may change. Always verify information with official sources before making decisions. Use responsibly."

Responsible gambling template

"Must be 21+ or the legal age in your jurisdiction. If you or someone you know has a gambling problem, call or text 1-800-GAMBLER."

05 Data Rights & Source Cleanup

The single most common mistake at this stage is assuming that because a page is public, the data on it can be reused commercially. **Public access is not commercial reuse permission.** Each source — stats, odds, news, headshots, logos — has its own licensing posture and needs to be audited before paid launch.

SOURCE	USED FOR	COMMERCIAL POSTURE
ESPN	Stats, schedules, news headlines	Public access is not a license. Use official feeds or a licensed aggregator.
CBS Sports	Stats, news	Same — get a licensed feed or restrict to headlines + outbound links.
RotoWire	Player news, projections	Subscription/licensed feed required for commercial reuse.
Odds / props feed	Lines, props, market data	Use a licensed provider with redistribution rights matched to your use.
Injury / news	Player status, beat reporter notes	Headlines + links are safer than reproducing body text. Confirm rights before paid use.
Player headshots	Player cards, props UI	League/players-association licensing typically required for commercial display.
Team logos	Branding, matchup cards	Team and league trademarks. Use only with a license or fall back to placeholders in commercial-safe mode.

Cleanup principles

- Inventory every data source the app touches: where it comes from, how it's accessed, and what's stored.
- Replace public-page collection with **licensed APIs or approved data providers** wherever data is shown commercially.
- Default unlicensed logos and headshots to placeholders behind commercial-safe mode.
- For news, prefer **headlines + outbound links** to source over reproducing article text.
- Maintain a Data Sources & Attribution page that lists every provider and their required attribution.

06

90-Day Roadmap

Sequenced so each month unblocks the next. Compliance foundation is cheap and removes the most obvious risk; data-source cleanup is the longest pole; commercial readiness is finalized only after the first two are in place.

MONTH 1

Compliance Foundation

- Ship the seven legal pages (Terms, Privacy, Responsible Gambling, PropIQ Methodology, AI/PropAI Limitations, Data Sources, Contact).
- Add age acknowledgement modal and persistent footer disclaimer.
- Replace any directive betting language in UI and marketing with analytical labels.
- Stand up a feedback / takedown / abuse mailbox and link it from Contact.

MONTH 2

Data-Source Cleanup

- Inventory every external data source and current access method.
- Migrate stats, odds, and props to licensed APIs or approved providers.
- Behind commercialSafeMode, swap unlicensed logos/headshots for placeholders.
- Convert news from full text to headlines + outbound source links.
- Publish the Data Sources & Attribution page reflecting actual providers.

MONTH 3

Commercial Readiness & Legal Review

- Engage an attorney with sports-betting / advertising experience to review Terms, Privacy, and Responsible Gambling.
- Decide on commercial model: subscription, pick sales, affiliate, or hybrid — and have counsel review the chosen path.
- If pursuing affiliates, vet operators and execute affiliate agreements; turn on deep links only for compliant operators.
- Add billing, refund, and tax handling if charging users.
- Run a pre-launch review of marketing copy, screenshots, and onboarding for prohibited language.

07 Practical Checklist

Run through these before public free beta, and again before any paid launch. Treat unchecked items as launch blockers.

LEGAL

- ☐ Terms of Service published and linked from footer.
- ☐ Privacy Policy published; lists processors and contact.
- ☐ Responsible Gambling page published with 21+ language and 1-800-GAMBLER.
- ☐ PropIQ Methodology and AI/PropAI Limitations pages live.
- ☐ Data Sources & Attribution page lists every provider.
- ☐ Contact / Support page reachable with monitored mailbox.
- ☐ Attorney review completed before charging users, adding affiliate links, selling picks, or marketing best bets.

DATA RIGHTS

- ☐ Inventory of every external data source (stats, odds, news, headshots, logos).
- ☐ Licensed APIs or approved providers in place for all commercially displayed data.
- ☐ Unlicensed logos and headshots default to placeholders in commercial-safe mode.
- ☐ News reduced to headlines + outbound links unless a license permits more.
- ☐ Attribution language matches each provider's contractual requirements.

USER PROTECTION

- ☐ Persistent in-app disclaimer on pages that show odds, props, or AI output.
- ☐ Age acknowledgement (21+ or legal local age) on first run.
- ☐ No directive betting language anywhere in UI, emails, or marketing.
- ☐ Analytical labels (Model Watchlist, Highest-Rated Props, Research Leans, PropEdge Signals, Market Notes) used consistently.
- ☐ Responsible-gambling resources visible from Responsible Gambling page and footer.

PRIVACY / SECURITY

- ☐ Data minimization: collect only what's needed for the feature.
- ☐ Subprocessor list maintained and disclosed in Privacy Policy.
- ☐ User rights flow (access, deletion, correction) documented and reachable.
- ☐ Secrets and API keys stored server-side; not exposed to client bundles.
- ☐ Backups and incident-response contact documented.

AI / PROP AI

- ☐ Every model output card carries the AI limitations note.
- ☐ Inputs and update cadence documented on the methodology page.
- ☐ Human-in-the-loop guidance: users told to verify before acting.
- ☐ Hallucination and stale-data risks called out where relevant.

LAUNCH

- ☐ Commercial-safe mode flag exists and has been tested end-to-end.
- ☐ Sportsbook deep links disabled unless a vetted affiliate agreement is signed.
- ☐ Marketing copy and screenshots reviewed for prohibited language.
- ☐ Pricing, billing, refund, and tax flows reviewed if charging users.
- ☐ Pre-launch attorney sign-off on Terms, Privacy, and Responsible Gambling.

FINAL REMINDER

An attorney should review PropEdge's posture **before** charging users, adding affiliate links, selling picks, or marketing best bets. The roadmap and checklist above reduce the surface area an attorney needs to cover; they do not replace that review.